

Senior Academy - IT training center

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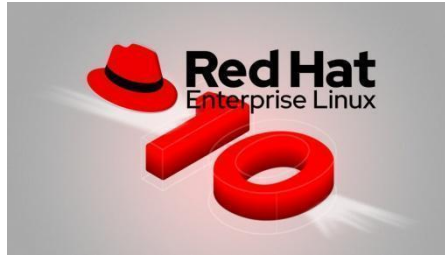
Linux System Administration Diploma



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Linux System Administration Diploma



Lab05

Password Policy & User Access Control

- **Group & User Setup:** Create a group with a specific GID and users with supplementary memberships.
- **Security Policies:** Enforce password aging, account expiration, and "change password on first login."
- **Ownership Control:** Assign directories to specific groups.
- **Access Management:** Use Symbolic and Octal methods to secure shared folders.

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Lab Objectives

This lab focuses on managing local identities and folder security. You will create users and a group, apply password and account expiry policies, and set up a shared directory with specific group ownership and restricted permissions for "others".

Scenario

You are the lead system administrator. You need to create a collaborative environment for two junior admins, **sysadmin1** and **sysadmin2**. You must ensure they have a shared workspace with restricted access and that their accounts follow specific security expiration policies.

Task 1: Group and User Creation

1. **Create a new group** named **sysadmins** and manually assign it the GID 35000.
2. **Create two users** named **sysadmin1** and **sysadmin2**. Ensure that **sysadmins** is their **supplementary group**.
3. **Set the initial password** for both users to **redhat**.

Task 2: Password Aging and Account Expiry

1. **Set the maximum password age** to **30 days** for both users so they are prompted to change it monthly.
2. **Set the account expiration date** for both users to exactly **90 days from today**. (Use the **date** command to calculate the correct string).
3. **Force an immediate password change** so that both users are required to set a new password the very first time they log into the system.

Task 3: Shared Directory and Permissions

1. **Create a directory** at the path **/opt/sysadmin_tools**.
2. **Change the group ownership** of this directory so it is owned by the **sysadmins** group.
3. **Using the Symbolic Method**, grant the group members **write** access to this directory.
4. **Using the Octal Method**, modify the permissions so that:
 - The **Owner** has full access (Read, Write, Execute).
 - The **Group** has full access (Read, Write, Execute).
 - **Others** have **no permissions** (cannot read, write, or enter the directory).

Task 4: Verification

1. **Verify the directory metadata:** Run a command to show the permissions, owner, and group of `/opt/sysadmin_tools`.
2. **Test User Access:**
 - Switch to `sysadmin1`.
 - Change the password as prompted.
 - Navigate to `/opt/sysadmin_tools` and create an empty file named `audit.txt`.
 - Switch to `sysadmin2` and verify you can see the file created by the first user.

You are Welcome